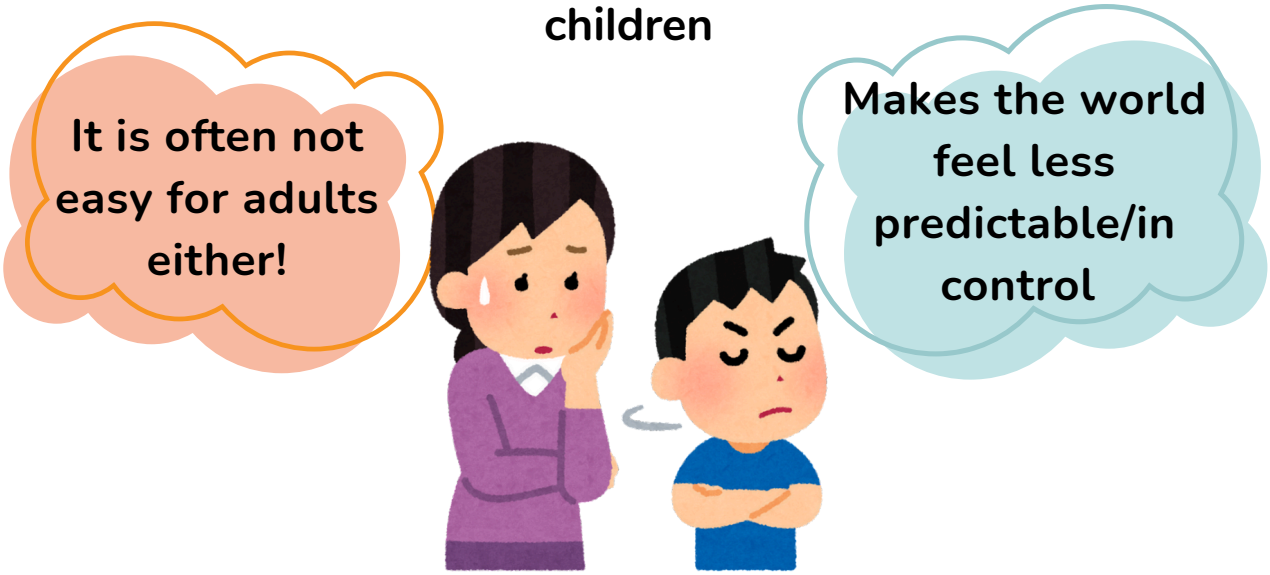
NAVIGATING CHANGE

<u>Change is inherently stressful and scary</u> for young children



These feelings are typically expressed as <u>temporary changes in behavior</u>

Developmental regressions (toileting accidents)	Whining, clinging to parents	More frequent meltdowns



ADAPTED FROM THE MOM POWER VIRTUAL GROUP CURRICULUM (MUZIK & ROSENBLUM ET AL., UNPUBLISHED MANUAL, 2021)

NAVIGATING CHANGE

<u>Changes that are big and/or unexpected</u> tend to be most challenging

Transitions at school, moving, and changes in family structure often lead to strong reactions





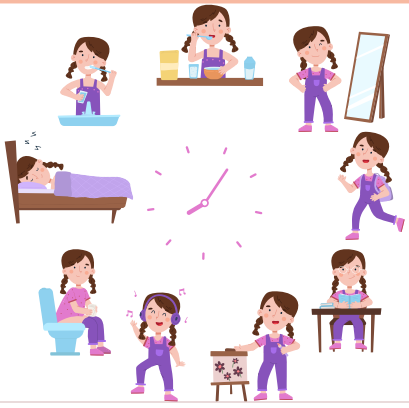


Your child will <u>need extra reassurance and support from you</u> to navigate these periods of time

A few minutes of quality time per day can make a big difference

Keeping routines as consistent as possible helps them feel more in control





ADAPTED FROM THE MOM POWER VIRTUAL GROUP CURRICULUM (MUZIK & ROSENBLUM ET AL., UNPUBLISHED MANUAL, 2021)

NAVIGATING CHANGE

STRATEGIES FOR NAVIGATING CHANGE

Use books and toys to help kids anticipate and process the change

- For example, books about becoming an older sibling and baby dolls can be helpful for preparing for a new baby
- It is normal and healthy for kids to express their wishes and fantasies (such as no longer having a sibling or staying in their old house) through play



READING TO GET READY

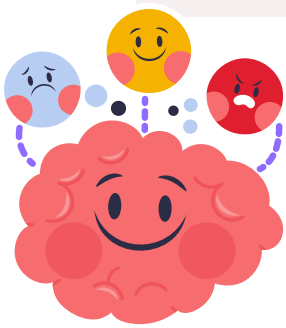


PLAYING TO PROCESS

STRATEGIES FOR NAVIGATING CHANGE

Don't panic if they express strong negative feelings about the change

- These feelings reflect one moment in time
- Your child likely has mixed feelings about the change





ADAPTED FROM THE MOM POWER VIRTUAL GROUP CURRICULUM (MUZIK & ROSENBLUM ET AL., UNPUBLISHED MANUAL, 2021)

NAVIGATING CHANGE

STRATEGIES FOR NAVIGATING CHANGE

<u>Validate all their feelings</u> about the change, not just the positive ones

"I bet it feels hard to have a baby sister sometimes. Sometimes I'm focused on her instead of you, and her cries are really loud!"

Giving them 'permission' to feel sad and mad makes it easier for them to acknowledge the positive feelings too

<u>Be proud of them</u> for tolerating the change, even though it was not always fun or easy



They are still learning how to be resilient!



ADAPTED FROM THE MOM POWER VIRTUAL GROUP CURRICULUM (MUZIK & ROSENBLUM ET AL., UNPUBLISHED MANUAL, 2021)